

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠J

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 7♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥3

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣A

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠7

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠4

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥4

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 5
 ♥ 6 3
 ♦ 10 8 7
 ♣ A J 10 9 2

♠ 4 2

♥ Q J 9 7 5

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7 5 3



♠ J 10 8 7

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 6 4 3

♣ 8 6 4

♠ A K 6 3

♥ A K 8 2

♦ K Q J

♣ K Q

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♠J			

SOUTH has a nice 2♣ opening hand.

With 8 points, NORTH can make a positive response so he bids his 5-card ♥ suit.

SOUTH likes ♥s, knows there are at least 33 points, but needs to make sure the opponents don't have two Aces so she uses Blackwood.

When NORTH shows one Ace SOUTH bids 6♥.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 10 2
 ♥ A Q J 10 5
 ♦ A K 2
 ♣ K

♠ 7 4

♥ 8 4

♦ 9 8 4 3

♣ Q 10 9 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 9 8 3

♥ K 7 2

♦ 6

♣ A 8 7 4

♠ 6 5

♥ 9 6 3

♦ Q J 10 7 5

♣ J 3 2

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♠	Pass	7♠	

All Pass

7♠ by East

Lead: ♥3

WEST opens 2♣ and is pleased when EAST makes a positive response of 2♠. His first step is to set the trump suit by bidding 3♠. There is NO chance that EAST will pass.

EAST now bids 4♣ a Control-showing bid. WEST continues Control-showing with 4♦.

That's enough for EAST to hear. She invokes Blackwood and learning they have all the Aces bids 7♠.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 3
 ♥ Q 6 4
 ♦ J 9 4
 ♣ A J 9 7 4

♠ K Q 8 6

♥ A K J 2

♦ A K Q

♣ 8 6



♠ 9 5

♥ 10 5 3

♦ 10 7 6 5 3

♣ K 10 2

♠ A J 10 7 2

♥ 9 8 7

♦ 8 2

♣ Q 5 3

NORTH has a minimum 2♣ opening.

SOUTH, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

NORTH shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give SOUTH an opportunity for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

SOUTH would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns to 4♠ which NORTH passes.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ 9 5 3

♠ J 10 8 7 5

♥ J 7 6

♦ 10 9 5

♣ 8 6



♠ A Q 9

♥ A K 2

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 7 4

♠ 4 2

♥ 10 9 4 3

♦ Q J 2

♣ K Q 10 2

EAST, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But WEST responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

EAST bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and WEST passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		2♣	
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♠ 7			

Board 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 8 3
♥ K
♦ K 10 8 5 4 3
♣ Q 10 2

♠ A K 9
♥ A J 8 2
♦ A 6
♣ A K 9 3



♠ 6 5 4
♥ 9 6 4 3
♦ Q J 9
♣ J 7 6

♠ Q J 7 2
♥ Q 10 7 5
♦ 7 2
♣ 8 5 4

NORTH opens 2♣ and SOUTH responds 2♦ showing fewer than 8 points.

NORTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

SOUTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead.

NORTH won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So NORTH shows her 4-card ♥ suit and SOUTH bids 4♥.

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♠4			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A Q 7 4

♠ 5 4 2
♥ J 10 9 7 6
♦ 2
♣ 10 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ K J 3

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 4 3
♦ Q J 10 9 5
♣ 9 6

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			
6NT by East			
Lead: ♥4			

EAST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to WEST's 2♣ opening bid.

WEST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

EAST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.